

Young Professionals Bootcamp (YPB) 2026 — Programme Reference

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Source: youngprofessionalsng.org

Purpose: Use this to calibrate application answers against what YPB actually selects for

What Is YPB?

The Young Professionals Bootcamp (YPB) is a 3-day in-residence leadership and enterprise programme designed to equip high-performing young Nigerians with critical skills and mentorship to inspire innovation, drive success in the marketplace, and transform the Nigerian economy.

300 candidates are selected from a large applicant pool to attend the intensive professional bootcamp. Selected candidates also have access to mentorship opportunities and seed funding to scale their entrepreneurial ventures.

The YPB has run for over a decade. To date: 500+ fellows, 7 cohorts, 100+ facilitators.

Eligibility Criteria

To be eligible, applicants must meet ALL of the following:

- Aged 20–35 years old by June 2026
 - Final year student or graduate from a tertiary institution
 - Nigerian citizen
 - Passionate about solving problems and thriving in Nigeria
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The Three Workstreams (Tracks)

Applicants are grouped into one of three tracks:

1. Corporate Career

Developing essential skills for climbing the corporate ladder and making an impact in established organisations.

2. Entrepreneurship

Learning how to build, scale, and sustain innovative ventures that solve real problems in Nigeria and beyond.

3. Creative Industry

Honing craft and learning the business of creativity across film, music, design, and the broader creative economy.

What Fellows Get

Professional Skills

Critical skills, tools, and resources for their chosen career via general leadership training and curated sessions per track (entrepreneurship, corporate, creative).

Mentorship

Direct engagement with established industry mentors across business, corporate career, and the creative industry.

Community & Networking

Peer connections with 299 other high-performing young Nigerians. Relationships that accelerate career trajectory short and long term.

Grant Funding

Fellows with existing businesses or ventures can pitch for a share of the ₦150 Million grant fund. This is optional — fellows who only want the bootcamp experience do not have to apply for the grant.

Programme Timeline

- Applications: Open now (as of April 2026)

- Bootcamp: June 2026, Lagos, Nigeria (in-person, residential)
 - Venue: Communicated to successful candidates only
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Grant Component — Key Details

- Up to ₦150 Million available across selected participants
 - Open to participants with **existing businesses or ventures**
 - Applicants pitch during the bootcamp for a chance to win
 - Grant application is optional — separate from the standard bootcamp application
 - Participants who only want the bootcamp should complete the standard application and ignore the grant section
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FAQs — Condensed

Cost: Free to apply. Free to attend if selected. Transport to/from bootcamp is not covered.

Format: In-person, 3-day residential bootcamp in Lagos. Some virtual pre-bootcamp activities for selected fellows.

Accommodation: Provided for all selected fellows for the duration of the bootcamp.

Dress code: Business casual. Comfortable clothing for sports/exercise also needed. Formal attire for the dinner.

Selection notification: Via email.

Transfer: Admission cannot be transferred to another person.

Lagos residents: All fellows must stay on camp for the full duration. No walk-in allowed.

Contact: platformypbteam@gmail.com

Application link: <https://tally.so/r/xXNg6G>

Previous Speakers (Signal of What YPB Values)

These speakers signal the calibre, sectors, and values YPB aligns with:

Speaker	Role	Relevance
Bolanle Austen-Peters	Founder, BAP Productions & Terrakulture	Film, creative industry infrastructure
Kemi Adetiba	Movie producer, Writer, Director	Nigerian film, creative entrepreneurship
Ojoma Ochai	Managing Director, CcHUB	Tech + creative economy intersection
Steve Babaeko	CEO, X3M Ideas	Advertising, brand, creative business
Gaise Baba	Singer and Songwriter	Music industry
Chika Nwobi	Founder, L5Lab	Tech entrepreneurship
Ibukun Awosika	Entrepreneur, Author, Speaker	Business building, Nigerian context
Dr. Omobola Johnson	Senior Partner, TLCom Capital	Investment, tech ecosystem
Deyemi Okanlawon	Actor and Creative Entrepreneur	Creative + business crossover
Lanre Adisa	MD, Noah's Ark Communications	Advertising, brand strategy
Kelechi Amadi-Obi	Photographer & Storyteller	Creative craft, visual storytelling

Pattern: YPB consistently features people who operate at the intersection of creative industry and business. They value building, not just practising a craft.

Faculty (Who Runs the Sessions)

Faculty	Organisation
Khafeel Dosunmu	McKinsey & Company
Abiola Adewole	Oxfordblue Limited
Abdulsamod Balogun	Generation (Global Marketing)

Funmi Thomas	Ernst & Young
Oluyemi Adeosun	Heirs Energies
Uzoamaka Amalu	Pirano Energy
Kingsley Oko	LATC
Lolade Alonge	Koolboks
Ayokunnu Ojeniyi	Reverso Business Services

Pattern: Faculty are operators, not academics. They run sessions on leadership, strategy, and career execution. They expect fellows to engage at a practitioner level.

Fellow Testimonials — What Past Fellows Say YPB Delivered

- “YPB provided stories of inspiring people who have been able to change their deplorable circumstances.” — Kayode Alabi, YPB 2017
- “The Platform YPB supported our business through enormous grant funding and free publicity on National TV.” — Adebowale Oparinu, YPB 2018
- “I left YPB with questions and friendship. Two years after, the friendship has evolved into fellowship, the questions have materialized into purpose.” — Abiodun Jinadu, YPB 2018
- “At a point when I was very confused about how to chart a course in my career, YPB came as a game changer.” — Victor Oyesina, YPB 2018
- “YPB was my first fellowship and it prepared me for leadership.” — Ehinze Emeka, YPB 2017

Key themes from testimonials: clarity of direction, peer networks that last, grant as a business accelerator, permission to believe in Nigeria as a place worth building in.

What This Means for Your Application

What YPB is NOT looking for:

- Generic ambition with no grounding in Nigeria
- Ideas without any execution or traction

- People who want to leave Nigeria, not build in it
- Pure corporates with no creative or entrepreneurial angle

What YPB IS looking for:

- Demonstrated problem-solving with Nigerian market context
- Ventures with real traction (even early stage) for the grant track
- Creative industry builders who understand both the craft and the business
- People who can articulate what Nigeria needs and how they're providing it

SyncMaster's strongest angles for this panel:

1. **Nollywood is explicitly in their orbit** — Kemi Adetiba, Bolanle Austen-Peters are past speakers. The panel understands this industry.
2. **Creative infrastructure, not just a creative** — SyncMaster is the business layer behind the music. That's the angle the entrepreneurship track rewards.
3. **Nigeria-first, Africa-scalable** — the thesis starts with Lagos/Nollywood and scales across sub-Saharan Africa. That's the transformation narrative YPB is built around.
4. **Grant-eligible** — existing product, live platform, real target users, clear revenue model. Not a concept.

Source: youngprofessionalsng.org — scraped May 2026. Verify timeline details before submission.